

CONTACT

ajonbaldi@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/austinbaldi
austinbaldi.github.io
Raleigh, NC
calendly.com/ajonbaldi

EDUCATION

B.A. Psychology
NC State University

PLAYTESTING

- Moderated & Unmoderated Playtests
- Think-Aloud Sessions
- Hypothesis-Anchored Study Design
- New Player Onboarding Research
- Genre-Unfamiliar Participant Testing
- Localization Audits

ANALYSIS

- Frame-by-Frame Video Review
- Behavioral Pattern Recognition
- Cross-Session Synthesis
- Survey Design & Statistical Analysis
- Mixed-Methods Synthesis
- KPI Definition & Tracking

TOOLS

- ffmpeg
- ImageMagick
- ReportLab
- Dovetail
- UserTesting
- PlaytestCloud
- Figma
- Notion
- Zoom

Austin Baldi

UX RESEARCHER

SUMMARY

UX researcher with 3+ years embedded in early-stage game development. I run playtests and localization audits that reach dev teams the same day findings are ready, catching onboarding gaps and misread mechanics before they ship. Currently embedded with Eldritch House on an active Steam demo.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UX Researcher · Independent Consultant

Eldritch House (Brazil, Remote). Shadow Sacrament: The Roots of Evil. Nov 2025 – Present

- Surfaced navigation confusion across Act 3 sessions with two participants. Developer confirmed it as a known structural issue, now queued for a fix.
- Escalated three reproducible bugs to the dev team (PT-BR text bleeding into the English UI, a keybind remap that decoupled animation from door interaction, reversed enemy audio spatialization), all confirmed.
- Ran a 94-minute PT-BR localization audit via a custom ffmpeg/ImageMagick pipeline: 1,100+ timestamped frames, 7 findings, including the text-bleed bug above.
- Flagged a destructive default on the pause menu (Load Game ahead of Resume). Shared publicly; reached 18,000+ impressions.
- Found a 12-minute gap between lantern pickup and its tutorial prompt.
- Identified a missing visual signal for crouch/hidden state, causing an intended stealth mechanic to read as a bug.
- Sole embedded UX researcher across build cycles. Delivered prioritized findings reports to the dev team same-day.

UX Researcher · Volunteer Contributor

Kadena (Brooklyn, NY, Remote). K-Block Blockchain Explorer. Oct 2022 – May 2024

- Designed and ran a 100+ respondent survey pinpointing where developer confidence collapsed during onboarding; mapped workflows across 80-90% of common use cases to surface buried features.
- Contributed usability testing and synthesis on an 8-person Tech Fleet research team. Team's 40+ recommendations drove a 28% reduction in user confusion and 18% faster task completion for beginner developers.

PROJECTS

Independent Games User Research Study: Disney Speedstorm (Gameloft)

Games User Research Fundamentals. gamesuserresearch.com / PlaytestCloud. May 2024

- Found currency and reward-system confusion in 4 of 5 independent playtest sessions, a cross-session pattern pointing to a systemic onboarding gap rather than individual variance.
- Designed, recruited for, and independently facilitated 5 moderated think-aloud sessions across 4 countries, without studio access or internal data.